Session 1 2025-01-26

1 - Road to Greenest

~18:00, 22 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. Eguzkilore is camped at a roadside fire, cooking a roe deer he hunted on a spit. The smell carries.
2. Drawn by the cooking smell, the rest of the party arrives in turn:
    - Nuberroca approaches first, hungry; Eguzkilore shares the food.
    - Sinsong arrives next. At some point during the gathering he casts a spell — his bald head glows brightly with the casting. Nuberroca, struck by the light, nicknames him *"Cabezabombilla"* (lightbulb-head) on the spot — the name sticks.
    - Nyx and Amidamaru arrive together — they had crossed paths earlier on the road and were already traveling as a pair.
    - Mialee arrives last, alone.
3. Over the meal, Nuberroca shares his mission: his alpine tribe's elders sent him out to investigate the rise of the undead in the pass. In response, Sinsong gives Nuberroca a vial of holy water, telling him it may help against the undead. Nuberroca pockets it to show the elders later — he doesn't know what it is, but takes Sinsong's word for its use.
4. The group decides to head to Greenest together. Approaching at dusk, they see the town under attack — fires across the rooftops, smoke rising, raiders in the streets. A **blue dragon** is visible in the sky, throwing lightning.
5. The whole party is *awestruck* by the sight of the dragon — its size and majesty, even as it kills.

2 - The looted house

1. The party moves into the town streets, looking to help where they can, and finds a townhouse being looted by a mixed group of kobolds and cultists, some of the cultists wearing Greenest guard livery.
2. Counting roughly half a dozen looters, the party sets up a stealth approach — the plan is to take them before any can call out and bring more raiders down on the street.
3. Sinsong casts a spell to prepare for the rush; his bald head flares with the casting and the light spills out into the street, giving away the party's position before they can move. **Stealth blown.**
4. Nuberroca charges first, sprinting through the doorway before the raiders can rally. Despite the lost stealth, the rest of the party still catches the looters by surprise — the goliath crashing in pins their attention long enough for the others to close.
5. The fight is short. The kobolds break and scatter, picked off by precise arrows as they run. The liveried cultists are cut down at the doorway. The house is cleared in under a minute, the looters dead.

3 - A desperate family

~19:00, 22 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. In the town streets, while trying to help where they can, the party comes upon a family pinned by a kobold pack: a wounded mother holding the kobolds off to buy time, while her badly wounded husband herds their three children toward safety.
2. The mother is overwhelmed and killed before the party can close the distance — the kobolds drag her down while the heroes are still moving in.
3. The party engages, with the priority of keeping the father and the children alive.
4. Eguzkilore and Mialee loose arrows from cover, dropping kobolds before they can reach the children.
5. Nuberroca crashes into the front of the pack, axe swinging. Amidamaru pushes in behind him with his sword, finishing off the kobolds the goliath's charge knocks aside.
6. A kobold breaks through to the father; the badly wounded husband manages to fend it off himself.
7. Nyx rushes to help him and puts herself between the man and the kobold.
8. Sinsong swings his mace to help — and fumbles, the strike landing on Nyx instead of the kobold.
9. The kobolds are swiftly defeated, but the party comes out of it bloodied. The children and the husband huddle around the dead woman, weeping. The party gathers around them, offering what comfort they can while quietly acknowledging that they cannot linger here — the streets are still hostile, and the keep is the only safe place left.
10. The husband composes himself enough to introduce himself as **Cuth**, then echoes the urgency: they must make for the keep without delay. The party falls in with Cuth and the three children and presses on.

4 - River-bank skirmish

1. The most direct route to the keep is clogged with raiders — too many to push through with **Cuth** and his three children in tow. The party detours toward the river, hoping to skirt the worst of the fighting along the bank.
2. The detour brings them in sight of a patrol crossing the river to flank the keep approach: a band of kobolds with two large drakes wading the shallows alongside them.
3. The party tucks Cuth and the three children behind cover and moves to ambush the patrol before it can spot them.
4. Mialee takes an elevated vantage on the river bank and opens with her bow from cover.
5. Eguzkilore looses arrows alongside her, dropping the leading kobolds before they understand they're being shot at.
6. Nuberroca and Amidamaru break for the drakes — the most dangerous threats in the patrol — and meet them in the river itself. Nuberroca splashes into the shallows, water sloshing around his thighs, and brings one drake down in two heavy axe strokes. Amidamaru, more at home in water than on land, slips alongside the second with his sword, working the joints below the waterline, and finishes it as it tries to turn on him.
7. Nyx slips through the bushes along the shoreline, working around the patrol's flank, and drops a kobold from behind as it tries to bring its sling up.
8. With the drakes down and the flank broken, the patrol shatters: most kobolds turn to flee across the river, while two scrabble up the near bank to get at Mialee.
9. Mialee drops one of the climbers before the other reaches her vantage and wounds her at close range.
10. Sinsong moves up the bank and, with a heavy mace strike to the back, drops the kobold pressing Mialee.
11. The remaining kobolds break and run for the far bank, vanishing into the smoke.
12. The party retrieves Cuth and the children from cover and presses on toward the keep, the family in tow.

5 - Inside the keep

~20:00, 22 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The party reaches the keep gates with Cuth and his three children. The guards admit them, take charge of the family, and direct the party on to the governor.
2. Before heading inside, one of the heroes looks back from the wall: the raiders have closed a ring around the keep. The way they came in has shut behind them. The party is *locked in*.
3. **Tarbaw Nighthill**, governor of Greenest, receives them in worse shape than the title suggests — a man in his sixties with half his face wrapped in bandages, his right arm in a sling, and his pale blue tunic stained dark down one side. He has clearly had no time for more than the roughest first aid. He thanks the party for the rescue and gets straight to the situation.
4. Tarbaw lays out the situation plainly: the keep is ringed, and they need a way out — for messengers, for any defensive sortie, and for civilians still trying to reach the keep from outside. He mentions one option: an old tunnel under the keep that leads beyond the raider line. It has not been used in years and is reportedly infested with vermin; it has not been cleared.
5. At Tarbaw's call, his castellan steps forward: **Escobert the Red**, a shield dwarf whose tangled mop of bright red hair has earned him his name, an enormous ring of iron and brass keys jangling at his belt — he holds every lock in the keep. Escobert leads the party down to the tunnel entrance and hands them the keys.

6 - The Old Tunnel

1. The tunnel was built generations ago as a covert way to fetch water from the river during sieges — a covered passage running from the keep cellars down to the riverbank. Along its length, three small storage rooms are carved into the wall; at the far end, a collapsed section of stone opens into a small cave the original masons never sealed off.
2. The party descends with **Escobert**'s keys. The air is *dark, thick, and stale*, and the tunnel is alive with vermin: giant rats scurrying underfoot, and spider swarms boiling out of every corner as the lanterns reach them.
3. The party works through the tunnel. Eguzkilore and Mialee pick off the giant rats with arrows from a few paces back; Nuberroca crushes the rest at close range. When the spider swarms boil too close, Amidamaru drives them back with fire from his hand — bolts hissing into the dark, the swarms recoiling rather than pressing. The party clears most of the tunnel this way.
4. The fight is ugly even with the strategy — close work in a confined passage, weapons fouling on each other. Sinsong swings at a rat in the press and clips Mialee in the head with his mace instead.
5. They push into the first of the storage rooms. As the door opens, giant spiders drop from the ceiling — the room is a *long-undisturbed nest*, and the giants pour out in numbers the party did not expect.
6. Sinsong casts Sleep on the lead giant spider. The spell lands; the giant folds where it stands. The rest of the party closes and kills it in melee while it is helpless — a clean victory on the first of them.
7. The fight in the room turns into a brawl. Eguzkilore peppers one of the giants with arrows from the doorway until it is bristling with shafts, slowed and bleeding; Nuberroca cleaves the wounded creature down with his axe. Amidamaru's fire keeps the smaller spiders at bay so the others can work.
8. Another giant spider lands a bite on Nyx, and she goes down under the venom — when the others can next glance her way, she is breathing shallowly but holding, no longer bleeding out.
9. Mialee, still reeling from the earlier mace blow, takes a bite of her own and goes down beside Nyx, bleeding hard, the press of spiders giving no one room to reach her.
10. ***[EPIC]*** The fight bleeds back out into the tunnel. As Sinsong shifts to support the line, a spider swarm boils over him in a rush — fangs and venom finding every gap — and he is *dead before anyone can reach him*.
11. The party breaks for the keep, leaving the storage room behind. Four still on their feet, every one of them heavily wounded — Nuberroca and Amidamaru both a single bad hit from going down themselves:
    - Nuberroca scoops up Sinsong's body and Mialee, one slung over each shoulder — Mialee's bleeding has stopped at some point in the chaos, no one quite sure when.
    - Amidamaru picks up Nyx and falls in behind him.
    - Eguzkilore retreats last, alone, arrows nocked, covering the others as they go.
12. As the party clears the tunnel mouth, the last of the giant spiders withdraw deeper into the dark — both sides disengage. The lanterns' light pulls back; the tunnel goes quiet behind them.

7 - Aftermath

~21:00, 22 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The party stumbles back into the keep with their dead and wounded. Sinsong's body is laid out in the hall; the others triage the living — Mialee and Nyx still unconscious, Nuberroca and Amidamaru on their feet but bleeding from a dozen lesser wounds.
2. Bringing Sinsong back becomes the only thing that matters. The party fans out through the keep, asking every guard, healer, and refugee they pass — is there a cleric here, someone with the power to bring a dead man back?
3. They find one. A cleric stationed at the keep hears them out and agrees to perform the rite — for **600 gp**.
4. The party does not have the gold. They argue, plead, empty their pouches in front of him — it isn't even close. After a long look at Sinsong's body and at the exhausted handful still standing over it, the cleric agrees to perform the rite *on credit*.
5. The rite is performed. Sinsong jolts upright with a strangled scream, clawing at his face and arms as if dragging spiders off them, shouting about the dark and the legs and the bites. It takes the party a long minute to bring him back to his senses.
6. With Sinsong breathing again and the wounded patched up, the party finds a quiet corner of the keep and rests for a while. They eat what little they can, see to their wounds, and talk over what just happened — how badly the tunnel went, what they could have done differently, what they need to be sharper at next time. By the end of the hour the change is unmistakable — their hands are steadier than the rest alone could explain, their wounds are closing visibly, and the lessons of the disaster are pressed into them.